

Rurik Kettleburn

Character Dossier

Shy, brilliant and defensive innkeeper of Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity

Overview

Rurik Kettleburn is a innkeeper living in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity. Rurik is 26 years old, originally from the Ninth Terrace, and is known around the Undermarket as shy, brilliant and defensive. In conversation Rurik gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Background

Rurik arrived in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity 18 years ago after leaving the Ninth Terrace under circumstances Rurik describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Halcyon Syndicate; the second was the one that stuck. Today Rurik works as a innkeeper near Sector 9 transit hub and is paid, when paid at all, in meridian scrip.

Rurik learned the trade from Juniper Stillwater, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Rurik's life is with Ingrid Thornbury, over a matter neither will explain. The person Rurik trusts most is Jorah Zimmerling.

Current goal: to be trusted by the Halcyon Syndicate again. Greatest fear: losing their sense of smell.

Personality and speech

Temperament: shy, brilliant and defensive.

Speech pattern: Rurik gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Tells: when lying, Rurik mentions Barnaby the mouse for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Rurik Kettleburn
<i>Role</i>	innkeeper
<i>Home</i>	Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity
<i>Hometown</i>	the Ninth Terrace
<i>Age</i>	26
<i>Favourite dish</i>	hand-rolled oat and ale bread
<i>Pet</i>	Barnaby, a mouse
<i>Lucky number</i>	883

<i>Workshop password</i>	copper-mirror
<i>Mentor</i>	Juniper Stillwater
<i>Rival</i>	Ingrid Thornbury
<i>Closest friend</i>	Jorah Zimmerling

Secret

Rurik sold a family heirloom to pay for Jorah Zimmerling's medicine and told everyone it was stolen.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Rurik: I am the innkeeper. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Rurik: Hand-rolled oat and ale bread. Do not tell Ingrid I said so.

Visitor: Is Barnaby yours?

Rurik: Barnaby belongs to nobody. Barnaby tolerates me. Lucky number is 883, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 29

Rurik repaired the wax seal at Sector 9 transit hub for Amadou, who paid in 5 meridian scrip and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. Rurik found a bolt of linen half-buried near Sector 9 transit hub and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Rurik for the password to the workshop. Rurik laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rurik was hired to carry a iron kettle from Sector 9 transit hub to the Glass District without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rurik was hired to carry a cracked compass from Sector 9 transit hub to the Glass District without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 2, autumn of year 29

Calloway came by asking about the census. Rurik said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Rurik moved the hand bell indoors, fed Barnaby, and wrote three lines to Juniper about whether the bridge will hold. The weather turned. Rurik moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Barnaby, and wrote three lines to Juniper about the old tunnels. Juniper visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rurik won 73 meridian scrip from Ingrid on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on hand-rolled oat and ale bread.

Entry 3, winter of year 29

Rurik closed early, walked to Kowloon Arcade, and watched the lights come on. Barnaby followed at a distance. the Halcyon Syndicate sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Rurik read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Rurik moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Barnaby, and wrote three lines to Juniper about the comet. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the Undermarket. Rurik pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.